SkillNavora

MODULE 8 HANDBOOK

Module 8: Content Builder and Email Development

4 sections, 31 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 8: Content Builder and Email Development

Level: Beginner to intermediate. Content Builder assets, responsive email design and dynamic content.

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Detailed lessons

Module 8

8.1 Content Builder assets and naming

WHAT IS IT?

> Content Builder stores emails, images, content blocks and templates in folders. Naming conventions make assets findable and safe to reuse.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Teams lose time looking for assets, and reused blocks change without warning if the naming and sharing are wrong.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Create folders by brand, campaign type and year.
2. Name blocks with a prefix such as blk_footer_brandA.
3. Use shared content blocks for footers and legal text.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> blk_footer_brandA is used in 40 emails; one edit updates them all.

COMMON ERRORS

Editing a shared block without checking every email that uses it.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How would you organise Content Builder for three brands?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Design a folder and naming structure for two brands.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

8.2 Responsive HTML email

WHAT IS IT?

Email HTML uses table-based layouts, inline CSS and media queries for mobile. Email clients have different support, so test in several clients.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

Most emails are opened on phones; a layout that breaks on mobile loses clicks.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Use a single-column table layout with a maximum width of 600px.
2. Inline the key styles.
3. Use alt text on images and a text fallback for buttons.
4. Test on mobile and desktop clients.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

A two-column layout collapses to one column below 480px using a media query.

CODE EXAMPLE, WITH LINE-BY-LINE NOTES

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body style="margin:0;background:#f4f4f7;font-family:Arial,sans-serif">
<table role="presentation" width="100%" cellpadding="0" cellspacing="0"><tr><td align="center">
  <table role="presentation" width="600" style="max-width:600px;background:#ffffff">
    <tr><td style="padding:24px;text-align:center;font-size:22px;font-
weight:bold;color:#2b1a66">Your new offers</td></tr>
    <tr><td style="padding:0 24px 24px;font-size:16px;color:#1d1b2e">
      Hi %%=ProperCase(AttributeValue("FirstName"))=%%, here are picks for you.
    </td></tr>
    <tr><td align="center" style="padding:0 24px 32px">
      <a href="https://example.com/offer" style="background:#5b37c9;color:#ffffff;padding:12px
22px;text-decoration:none;border-radius:6px">See offers</a>
    </td></tr>
  </table>
</td></tr></table>
</body>
</html>
```

COMMON ERRORS

Relying on CSS features that many clients ignore.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Why are email layouts built with tables?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Build a 600px responsive promotional email with a header, hero, two columns and a button.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Campaign Monitor: HTML email guide

8.1 Content Builder: every topic explained

Content Builder interface. The library to create and organise content.

Asset management. Creating, editing, reusing and archiving assets.

Folder organisation. Folders by brand, campaign and type.

Content blocks. Reusable pieces such as headers, footers and offers.

Templates. Layouts that emails start from.

Images. Uploaded images, optimised for email size.

Documents. Files such as PDFs linked from emails.

Dynamic content. Blocks whose content changes by rules.

Reusable content. Blocks shared in many emails so one edit updates them all.

Asset naming conventions. Consistent asset names for findability.

8.2 Email Design: every topic explained

Email layout. Header, hero, body, call to action and footer in a clear hierarchy.

Responsive email design. Layouts that adapt to screen size.

Email rendering. How email clients display HTML; each client differs.

Mobile compatibility. Readable on phones: single column, large text and tappable buttons.

Accessibility. Alt text, contrast, real text instead of images of text, and a logical reading order.

Typography. Web-safe font stacks and readable sizes.

Image optimisation. Compressed images with correct width and height.

Call-to-action design. Clear, single primary action with a visible button.

8.3 Dynamic Content: every topic explained

Dynamic content blocks. Blocks that show different content by audience rules.

Personalisation. Inserting subscriber data into content.

Conditional content. Show or hide sections based on data.

Content rules. The conditions that decide which content variant shows.

Audience-based content. Content variants for segments.

Personalised recommendations. Product suggestions based on data or a recommendation feed.

8.4 Email Testing: every topic explained

Preview and test. Preview the email and send tests.

Subscriber preview. Preview as a specific subscriber to check personalisation.

Personalisation testing. Check personalisation with missing and unusual values.

Link testing. Click every link and check tracking.

Rendering testing. Check display in major email clients with a testing tool.

Mobile testing. Check on phones and narrow screens.

Email client compatibility. Confirm the email works in the clients your audience uses.